



COUNSELING SKILLS TO FACILITATE SELF MANAGEMENT

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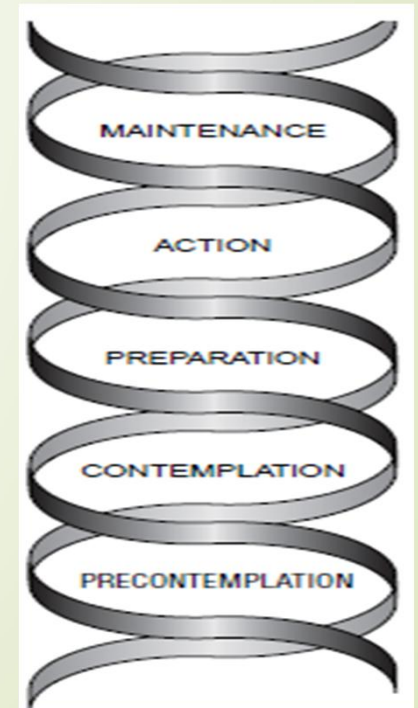


Objectives

- Define the stage of change (transtheoretical model)
- Describe each stage
- Understand steps for each stage
- Apply eight motivational strategies to nutrition-related adherence problems
- Understand how to apply the skills with clients

Stage of change (transtheoretical model)

- The stage of change provide a basis for facilitating a state of readiness or eagerness to change.
- Include five stages through which people pass in the course of changing a behavior:
 - precontemplation
 - contemplation
 - preparation
 - action
 - maintenance



Precontemplation

- the entry point to the process of change.
- This is the point at which the client has not even contemplated having a problem or needing to make a change.
- Statements like, “I’m not interested in what I eat,” may be common.
- Includes matching strategies with client’s stage of change.
- A person in the precontemplative stage needs information and feedback to raise his or her awareness of the problem and possibility of change. (e.g. disadvantages of not following the diet, and advantages of following the diet)
- Nutrition advice for eating changes is **counterproductive** at this point.
- Tasks within this stage of change are aimed at **consciousness-raising**.



Contemplation

- Once some awareness of the problem arises, the person enters a period of **ambivalence**
- The contemplator considers change and rejects it.
- Note that behavior is influenced by beliefs and attitudes.
- This is the **most common stage** for clients to come to the nutrition counselor for assistance in changing eating behaviors.
- The nutrition counselor's task at this stage is to help tip the balance in favor of change.
- work through ambivalence begin with the disadvantages and end with the advantages.

Preparation

- When the balance tips and the advantages outweigh the disadvantages, the client is in the preparation stage.
- At this stage, the client may say the following: “I’ve got to start eating more low-fat dairy products! This is serious! Something has to change. What can I do? How can I change?”
- The nutrition counselor’s task when a client is in the preparation stage is not one of motivating, but rather, **matching**.
- the client needs help in finding:
 - a change strategy or
 - a goal that is acceptable, accessible, appropriate, and effective.



Action

- is the most often termed *counseling*.
- The client engages in actions that bring about change.
- The goal during this stage is to produce a change in the problem area.
- This stage is characterized by client commitment to making change.
- This is the time at which the helping relationship between nutrition counselor and client.



Maintenance

- Making a change does not guarantee maintenance of that change.
- Obviously, human experience includes good intentions and initial changes, followed by minor (“slips”) or major (“relapses”) steps backward.
- During the maintenance stage, the challenge is to sustain the change accomplished by previous action and to prevent relapse.
- Slips and relapses are normal, expected occurrences to change any long-standing pattern of behavior.
- The nutrition counselor’s task here is to help the client avoid discouragement and demoralization, continue contemplating change, renew preparation, and resume action and maintenance efforts.

Steps for each stage

Stages of Change	Ten Steps to Promote Change	
Pre-contemplation	<u>STEP 1</u>	Providing Information on Risk
Contemplation	<u>STEP 2</u>	Outlining Personal Priorities
	<u>STEP 3</u>	Listing Possible Lifestyle Goals
	<u>STEP 4</u>	Listing Advantages of Change
	<u>STEP 5.</u>	Listing Disadvantages of Change
	<u>STEP 6</u>	Weighing the Advantages & Disadvantages of Change
Preparation	<u>STEP 7</u>	Preparing an Action Plan
Action	<u>STEP 8</u>	Taking Action
Maintenance	<u>STEP 9</u>	Maintaining Change
Relapse and Recycle	<u>STEP 10</u>	Learning from Backsliding



Motivational Strategies

- Keeping in mind the stages of change, the nutrition counselor might ask this question, “What strategies can a counselor use to enhance motivation for change?”
- There are identifiable factors that motivate people to change:
 1. giving advice
 2. identifying and removing barriers
 3. providing choices
 4. decreasing desirability of a present behavior
 5. practicing empathy
 6. providing feedback
 7. clarifying goals
 8. active helping

Motivational Strategies (Cont'd)

1. giving advice:

- ✓ Advice should clearly identify the problem or risk area, explain why change is important, and advocate specific change.

2. identifying and removing barriers:

- ✓ Barriers, such as cost, transportation, child care, shyness, etc, may interfere not only with beginning a dietary intervention, but with change efforts more generally.
- ✓ The nutrition counselor identifies barriers, the task is to assist the client in practical problem-solving.

3. providing choices:

- ✓ Offering clients choices among alternative approaches may decrease resistance and dropout rates and may improve goal attainment and outcomes.

Motivational Strategies (Cont'd)

4. decreasing desirability of a present behavior:

- ✓ It is important in the contemplation stage.
- ✓ Motivation strategies for the contemplation stage involve removing weights from the status quo side of the balance, and increasing weights on the change side of the scales.
- ✓ An important task for the nutrition counselor is to identify the client's positive incentives for continuing his or her present behavior.

5. practicing empathy:

- ✓ It has been indicated that practicing empathy with client can lead to low levels of client resistance and greater long-term behavioral change.
- ✓ It is a learnable skill to understand another's meaning through the use of reflective listening, whether or not the listener has actually had similar experiences.

Motivational Strategies (Cont'd)

6. providing feedback:

- ✓ Providing clients with feedback on changes in dietary intake is valuable to future change.
- ✓ People sometimes fail to change because they do not receive sufficient feedback about their current situation.

7. clarifying goals:

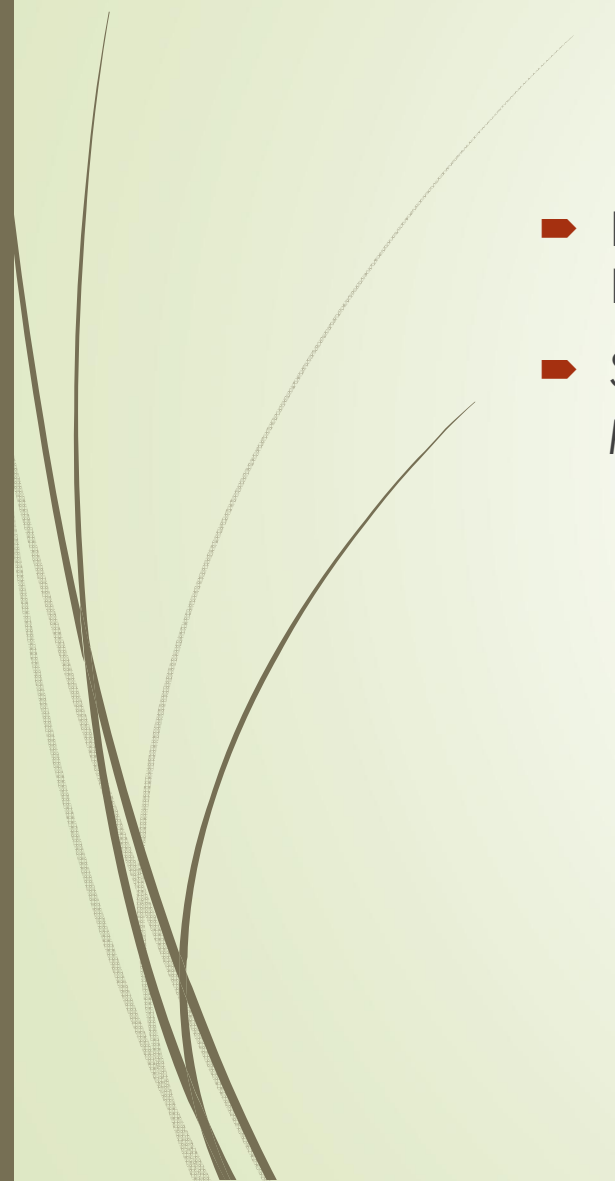
- ✓ Clients must see goals as realistic and attainable, or they will expend little effort to reach the goal, even if they acknowledge it as important.

8. active helping:

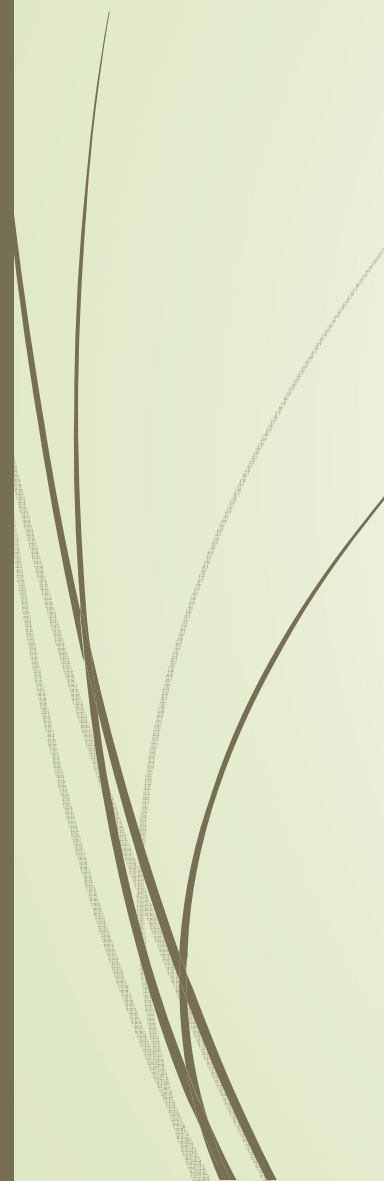
- ✓ At the end of a session, keep directions clear.
- ✓ Always be sure to leave clients with a sense of hope, not shame.
- ✓ Provides the client with a few clear positive steps toward dealing with backward slips.



References



- Prochaska, J., Norcross, J., & DiClemente, C. (1994). *Changing for good*. New York, NY: Avon Books.
- Snetselaar, L. G. (2009). *Nutrition counseling skills for the nutrition care process*. Sudbury, Mass: Jones and Bartlett.



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